
Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board

October 12, 2021

Ms. Barbara Romero, Director and General Manager
City of Los Angeles, Bureau of Sanitation
1149 S. Broadway 9th Floor
Los Angeles, CA 90015

Dear Ms. Romero:

APPROVAL OF WORKPLAN: NATIONAL POLLUTANT DISCHARGE ELIMINATION SYSTEM (NPDES) PERMIT – STATE OF COMPLETION FOR TERMINAL ISLAND WATER RECLAMATION PLANT WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS AND NPDES PERMIT, CITY OF LOS ANGELES BUREAU OF SANITATION (ORDER NUMBER R4-2021-0095, NPDES NUMBER CA0053857, CI NUMBER 2171)

On June 10, 2021, the Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board (Los Angeles Water Board) adopted Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) and an NPDES permit (Order Number R4-2021-0095) for the City of Los Angeles' (City's) Terminal Island Wastewater Treatment Plant (Facility). Pursuant to section 6.3.2.c. of Order Number R4-2021-0095, the City is required to submit a discharge phase-out workplan to the Executive Officer of the Los Angeles Water Board for approval no later than three (3) months from the effective date of the Order. The Order became effective on August 1, 2021. The discharge phase-out workplan shall describe plans for the Advanced Water Purification Facility (AWPF) for water recycling and the volume of recycled water for each end user, and a detailed schedule to cease the discharge of the tertiary-treated effluent from the Facility to the Los Angeles Outer Harbor by December 31, 2024.

On September 7, 2021, the Los Angeles Water Board received the discharge phase-out workplan, "Workplan: National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES) Permit – State of Completion" (Workplan), from the City via email. This Workplan provides the following information:

1. The City executed a 30-year agreement with the Water Replenishment District of Southern California (WRD) in December 2018 to deliver up to 9.5 million gallons per day (mgd) of recycled water to the Dominguez Gap Barrier (Barrier). The WRD agreed to construct two recycled water distribution systems. The Second Gap Connection Pipeline Project (Second Gap Connection) and the Harbor Recycled Water System Potable Backup Project (Potable Backup Project) are expected to be completed in the middle of 2023 and by the end of 2024, respectively. The Second Gap Connection project will provide a second connection to the Barrier. The Potable

Backup Project will provide 10 to 14 mgd of potable water back-up capacity to the Harbor Recycled Water System.

2. In February 2019, the City completed Phase I of the Machado Lake Pipeline Project, which is a portion of the distribution system connecting the recycled water from the AWPf to the three major recycled water customers: WRD, Ultramar, and Air Products. The City is in construction for Phase II, which installs a pipeline to complete a loop in the Harbor Recycled Water System. Two jacking locations and associated projects to close the loop were completed in January 2021. Phase II is scheduled to be completed by the end of November 2021.
3. The City completed the recycled water service connection and the service agreement with Ultramar in January 2021. The service agreement with Air Products is expected to be executed in Spring 2022. The combined peak demand for Air Products and Ultramar is 3 mgd. Before Ultramar and Air Products use the recycled water from the AWPf, they have to complete on-site improvements, which consist of installing piping and equipment so that they can transition to accepting recycled water and transition back to using potable water if recycled is not available. The City will provide financial incentives to Ultramar and Air Products for their on-site improvements. Ultramar and Air Products estimate that on-site retrofits will be completed by the end of 2022 and in early 2023, respectively.
4. By December 31, 2024, the City will complete all upgrades to the AWPf at the Facility to ensure full advanced water treatment quality, resiliency, reliability, and safety for incoming municipal wastewater flows. The current production capacity of the AWPf is 12 mgd.
5. Additional upcoming and future Capital Improvement Projects (CIPs) will improve resiliency and reliability of the AWPf. These CIPs, currently in various stages of design or construction, include (1) AWPf Phase 1 Chemical Piping Replacement, (2) Microfiltration System Replacement, (3) Addition of Ammonia Injection System to Advanced Oxidation Process (AOP), and (4) Addition of an Off-spec Diversion Line.

The Los Angeles Water Board has reviewed the Workplan and finds that the City adequately addressed requirements for the phase-out of effluent discharge from the Facility. The Los Angeles Water Board approves the Workplan to phase out the effluent discharge from the Facility to the Los Angeles Outer Harbor.

In addition to the effluent discharge phase-out, Los Angeles Water Board staff would like to schedule a meeting with the City to discuss the long-term disposal options for brine wastes generated by the AWPf. Los Angeles Water Board staff will follow up with you in the next few weeks to schedule a meeting.

Please do not hesitate to contact Dr. Don Tsai at Don.Tsai@waterboards.ca.gov or Dr. Jeong-Hee Lim at Jeong-Hee.Lim@waterboards.ca.gov with any questions or concerns you may have.

Sincerely,

Renee Purdy
Executive Officer

cc: See Mailing List

Mailing List (Via Email Only)

United States Environmental Protection Agency, Region 9, Permits Branch (WTR2-3)
United States Army Corps of Engineers
State Water Resources Control Board, Office of Chief Counsel
NOAA, National Marine Fisheries Service
Department of Interior, U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service
Department of Fish and Wildlife, Region 5
Los Angeles County Department of Public Works
Los Angeles County, Bureau of Sanitation
California Coastal Commission, South Coast Region
California Coastal Conservancy
Los Angeles County Department of Public Health
Water Replenishment District of Southern California
Heal the Bay
Environmental Now
Ventura Coastkeeper
Los Angeles Waterkeeper
Natural Resources Defense Council
PG Environmental